

Alvi Ataur Khalil

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CURRENT POSITION

Southern Illinois University, Carbondale, IL, USA

Aug. 2025 - Present

Tenure-Track Assistant Professor, Computer Science, School of Computing

KEY ACCOLADE/ACCOMPLISHMENTS

- Published over twenty peer-reviewed papers (16 as first author) in top-tier venues including ACSAC, DSN, ISQED, IEEE CNS, IEEE LCN, IEEE ICMLA, IEEE SMC, ACM DLT, and Elsevier Computer Networks, spanning blockchain security, UAV autonomy and defense, and the privacy and security of large language models.
- Principal Investigator on the NSF NAIRR Pilot Award (#NAIRR260054), securing 10,000 GPU-hours on NCSA's Delta supercomputer and NSF I-Corps Award (#2637735), securing \$50K USD for deep tech commercialization.
- Awarded one U.S. Patent (US 12,566,450 B2) on federated deep reinforcement learning for UAV trajectory planning against hostile defense systems.
- Selected as an IFLIP2 Fellow (2026) under the NSF IUSE initiative (Award #2439762) for contributions to STEM education reform initiative.
- Received multiple awards, including Outstanding Graduate Scholar of the Year at FIU (2023-24), Second Place in Engineering at the FIU Graduate School Scholarly Forum 2023, IEEE Upsilon Pi Epsilon (UPE) Honor Society Scholarship 2024, and the NSF Student Travel Grant acknowledging academic excellence and research potential

RESEARCH INTERESTS

- Blockchain security, with a focus on vulnerabilities in decentralized off-chain Layer 2 (L2) systems and mitigation.
- Artificial intelligence (AI)-based autonomous systems, particularly utilizing Reinforcement Learning (RL) for UAVs.
- Machine learning, data-driven security solutions, and threat detection techniques for the cybersecurity of cyber-physical system (CPSs).

FUNDED RESEARCH PROJECTS

I-Corps: Translation potential of Automated AI Reliability Evaluation Platform

Sep. 2026 – Aug. 2027

- Funding organization: National Science Foundation (NSF)
- Role: Principal Investigator (PI)
- Award ID: 2637735
- Award Amount: \$50,000 USD to accelerate the commercialization of our deep-tech innovation.

SplitMind: Multimodal AI via Split Learning for Privacy-Critical Visual Intelligence

May 2026 – May 2027

- Funding organization: National Science Foundation (NSF)'s National Artificial Intelligence Research Resource (NAIRR) Pilot Resource Grant
- Role: Principal Investigator (PI)
- Award ID: NAIRR260054
- Resources: 10,000 GPU Hours on NCSA Delta GPU (Delta GPU)

EDUCATION

Florida International University (FIU), Miami, FL, USA

Aug. 2020 - Aug. 2025

M.S. leading to Ph.D. in Electrical and Computer Engineering

FIU, Miami, FL, USA

Aug. 2020 - Jul. 2024

M.S. in Computer Engineering

Khulna University of Engineering and Technology (KUET), Khulna, Bangladesh

Apr. 2014 - Mar. 2018

B.Sc. in Computer Science and Engineering

US Patent

- [1] Mohammad Ashiqur Rahman and **Alvi Ataur Khalil**.
“Federated Deep Reinforcement Learning-Assisted UAV Trajectory Planning Against Hostile Defense System.”
Patent number: **US 12,566,450B2**; Publication date: July 10, 2025; Date of Patent: **Mar 3, 2026**

Journal Paper

- [2] Tayebbeh Rajabi*, **Alvi Ataur Khalil***, Mohammad Hossein Manshaei, Mohammad Ashiqur Rahman, Mohammad Dakhilalian, Maurice Ngouen, Murtuza Jadliwala, and A. Selcuk Uluagac.
“Feasibility Analysis for Sybil Attacks in Shard-Based Permissionless Blockchains.”
In: ACM Distributed Ledger Technologies (DLT): Research and Practice.
Publication date: 14 December, 2023
- [3] **Alvi Ataur Khalil**, Mohamed Y Selim, and Mohammad Ashiqur Rahman.
“Deep Learning-based Energy Harvesting with Intelligent Deployment of RIS-assisted UAV-CFmMIMOs.”
In: ELSEVIER Computer Networks.
Publication date: 01 June, 2023. *Impact factor:* 4.4
- [4] A. H. M. Jakaria, Mohammad Ashiqur Rahman, Muneeba Asif, **Alvi Ataur Khalil**, Hisham A. Kholidy, Matthew Anderson, and Steven Drager.
“Trajectory Synthesis for a UAV Swarm Based on Resilient Data Collection Objectives.”
In: IEEE Transactions on Network and Service Management (TNSM).
Publication date: 25 October, 2022. *Impact factor:* 4.7

Conference Papers (Blockchain Security)

- [5] **Alvi Ataur Khalil** and Mohammad Ashiqur Rahman.
“xPoz-Hub: Privacy Infiltration in Payment Channel Hubs through Balance Probing and Transaction Discovery.”
In: 2025 Annual Computer Security Applications Conference (ACSAC).
- [6] **Alvi Ataur Khalil**, MGM Mehedi Hasan, and Mohammad Ashiqur Rahman.
“OptiGame: Game-Theoretic Enhancements for Optimistic Rollups through Bayesian Strategies”
In: 2025 EAI International Conference on Security and Privacy in Communication Networks (SecureComm).
- [7] **Alvi Ataur Khalil** and Mohammad Ashiqur Rahman.
“RollGuard: Defending RPC Manipulation Attacks in Optimistic Rollups with Graph-Based AI.”
In: 2025 26th International Symposium on Quality Electronic Design (ISQED).
- [8] **Alvi Ataur Khalil** and Mohammad Ashiqur Rahman.
“PAROLE: Profitable Arbitrage in Optimistic Rollup with ERC-721 Token Transactions.”
In: 2024 54th Annual IEEE/IFIP International Conference on Dependable Systems and Networks (DSN).
Publication date: 30 August, 2024. *Acceptance rate:* 20%.
- [9] **Alvi Ataur Khalil**, Mohammad Ashiqur Rahman, and Hisham A. Kholidy.
“FAKey: Fake Hashed Key Attack on Payment Channel Networks.”
In: 2023 IEEE Conference on Communications and Network Security (CNS).
Publication date: 27 October, 2023. *Acceptance rate:* 28%.
- [10] **Alvi Ataur Khalil**, Javier Franco, Imtiaz Parvez, Selcuk Uluagac, Hossain Shahriar, and Mohammad Ashiqur Rahman.
“A Literature Review on Blockchain-enabled Security and Operation of Cyber-Physical Systems.”
In: 2022 IEEE 46th Annual Computers, Software, and Applications Conference (COMPSAC).
Publication date: 10 August, 2022.

Conference Papers (Privacy and Security of Large Language Models)

- [11] Abdullahil Kafi and **Alvi Ataur Khalil**
“RAG-Narok: Retrieval-Aware Knowledge Corpus Poisoning in RAG with Source-specific Refutation.”
In: 2026 IEEE International Conference on Machine Learning and Applications (ICMLA 2026). [Accepted]
- [12] Md Khalid Syfullah and **Alvi Ataur Khalil**
“U-Shaped Split Learning for Visual Question Answering with Contribution-Aware Weighted Aggregation.”
In: 2026 IEEE International Conference on Systems, Man, and Cybernetics (SMC 2026). [Accepted]

[13] Md Khalid Syfullah and **Alvi Ataur Khalil**

“LLM-Based Schema-Aware Split Learning for Privacy-Preserving Mental Distress Prediction Across Heterogeneous Surveys.”

In: 2026 IEEE International Conference on E-Health Networking, Applications and Services (IEEE HealthCom 2026). [Accepted]

Conference Papers (UAV: Autonomous Navigation, Energy Harvesting, and Security)

[14] Alvaro Alva, Luis Martinez Moreno, Muneeba Asif, **Alvi Ataur Khalil**, Mohammad Ashiqur Rahman, Alfredo Cuzzocrea, and Shahriar Hossain.

“Secured UAV Navigation: A Novel Intrusion Detection System Based on PWM Signal Analysis.”

In: 2024 11th IEEE Swiss Conference on Data Science (SDS).

Publication date: 18 September, 2024.

[15] **Alvi Ataur Khalil** and Mohammad Ashiqur Rahman.

“Adaptive Neuro-Fuzzy Inference System-Based Lightweight Intrusion Detection System for UAVs.”

In: 2023 IEEE 48th Conference on Local Computer Networks (LCN).

Publication date: 06 September, 2023.

Acceptance rate: 26%.

[16] **Alvi Ataur Khalil** and Mohammad Ashiqur Rahman.

“FeD-UP: Federated Deep Reinforcement Learning-based UAV Path Planning against Hostile Defense System.”

In: 18th International Conference on Network and Service Management (CNSM).

Publication date: 02 December, 2022.

Acceptance rate: 19%.

[17] **Alvi Ataur Khalil***, Alexander J Byrne*, Mohammad Ashiqur Rahman, and Mohammad Hossein Manshaei.

“REPlanner: Efficient UAV Trajectory-Planning using Economic Reinforcement Learning.”

In: 2021 IEEE International Conference on Smart Computing (SMARTCOMP).

Publication date: 08 October, 2021.

Acceptance rate: 30%.

[18] **Alvi Ataur Khalil**, Mohamed Y Selim, and Mohammad Ashiqur Rahman.

“CURE: Enabling RF Energy Harvesting using Cell-Free Massive MIMO UAVs Assisted by RIS.”

In: 2021 IEEE Conference on Local Computer Networks (LCN).

Publication date: 07 September, 2021.

Acceptance rate: 28%.

Other Conference Papers

[19] Sibtain Syed, **Alvi Ataur Khalil**, Kishor Datta Gupta, Saima Jabeen, and Mohammad Ashiqur Rahman.

“Query-Based Model Extraction Attack on GCN: A Surrogate Model Technique for Non-Euclidean Data.”

In: AAAI Fall Symposium Series 2025 (AAAI FSS’25)

[20] Md Hasan Shahriar, **Alvi Ataur Khalil**, Mohammad Ashiqur Rahman, Mohammad Hossein Manshaei, and Dong Chen.

“iAttackGen: Generative Synthesis of False DataInjection Attacks in Cyber-physical Systems.”

In: 2021 IEEE Conference on Communications and Network Security (CNS).

Publication date: 10 February, 2022.

Acceptance rate: 26%.

[21] **Alvi Ataur Khalil**, Al Mahmud, and Asif Ahmed.

“FicBit: An improved Fractal Image Compression using Bio-Inspired Techniques.”

In: 2021 5th International Conference on Electrical Information and Communication Technology (EICT)

Publication date: 16 March, 2022.

[22] Nur Imtiazul Haque*, **Alvi Ataur Khalil***, Mohammad Ashiqur Rahman, M Hadi Amini, and Sheikh Iqbal Ahamed.

“BIOCAD: Bio-Inspired Optimization for Classification and Anomaly Detection in Digital Healthcare Systems.”

In: 2021 IEEE International Conference on Digital Health (ICDH).

Publication date: September 05, 2021.

Acceptance rate: 20%.

***Co-first Author**

POSTERS/ABSTRACTS

- Represented FIU at the Academy of Science, Engineering, and Medicine of Florida (ASEMFL) by presenting poster titled “State-root manipulation attack in optimistic rollup through updating the remote procedure call (RPC) address” at the Annual Meeting 2024.
- Presented a poster titled “SHiP: Securing Hashed Timelock Contracts in Payment Channel Networks” at the 2023 IEEE Conference on Communications and Network Security (CNS 2023).
- Presented a poster titled “Data-driven ANFIS-based IDS for UAV” at the FIU UGS Scholarly Forum 2023.

HONORS AND AWARDS

- Awarded the **Outstanding Graduate Scholar of the Year** by Outstanding Student Life Awards organized by the Division of Academic & Student Affairs at FIU for research contributions in the academic year 2023-24.
- Awarded FIU University Graduate School (UGS) **Dissertation Year Fellowship** for Spring and Summer 2025.
- Awarded **NSF Student Travel Grant** for the 2023 IEEE CNS, acknowledging academic excellence and research potential in secured communications and networking (Award #2331646).
- Awarded the Upsilon Pi Epsilon (UPE) Honor Society Scholarship 2024 from the Computing Sciences and the IEEE Computer Society (the largest association of computer professionals).
- Honored with **Second Place (among 81 posters)** in the Engineering category for the poster titled “Data-driven ANFIS-based IDS for UAV” at the FIU GSAW Scholarly Forum 2023.
- Completed the Fall 2021 **NSF I-Corps cohort as Entrepreneurial Lead** of team 2426, funded by National Science Foundation (NSF) under award #2138301. (Credential).
- Inducted by the Honor Society of **Phi Kappa Phi** by the election of the chapter at FIU for outstanding academic achievements in the academic year 2020-2021.
- Deans List award of the Faculty of EEE for Excellent Academic Performance in the 2016-17 and 2015-16 sessions.
- Awarded a general scholarship for outstanding performance in the Secondary School Certificate Examination during the 2010-11 academic year, as well as for exceptional results in the Higher Secondary School Certificate Examination in the 2012-13 academic year.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Analytics for Cyber Defense (ACyD) Laboratory, FIU, Miami, FL, USA Aug. 2020 - Jul. 2025
Graduate Assistant, Department of Electrical and Computer Engineering

- Collaborated and made substantive contributions to 1 NSF project, 1 NSA project, and 1 DOE project.
- Articulated defense mechanisms against cyber attacks on off-chain L2 solutions for **Blockchain**.
- Designed intelligent navigation for military drones/UAVs in hostile territory using reinforcement learning.
- Articulated deep learning-based energy harvesting models for IoT devices using cell-free massive MIMOs, and intelligent reflecting surfaces.
- Mentored 7 undergraduate and graduate researchers supported by NSF/NSA/DOE projects.

MazeGeek Technologies BD Ltd., Dhaka, Bangladesh Aug 2018 - Jul. 2019
Software Developer

- Developed and launched 5 Android applications that collectively achieved over 1,000 downloads, enhancing user engagement by 15% within the first six months of release.
- Designed robust project architectures that streamlined application functionality, resulting in a 10% reduction in development time and improved performance.
- Managed client requirements and documentation, ensuring 100% adherence to project specifications and timelines.
- Participated in key client meetings, fostering relationships and securing 2 new contracts through effective communication and project presentations.

Daffodil International University (DIU), Dhaka, Bangladesh May 2018 - Jun. 2018
Lecturer, Department of Computer Science and Engineering

- Conducted classes and lab sessions for over 60 students in Artificial Intelligence (CSE 412 & 413), achieving a 90% student satisfaction rating through engaging instructional methods.
- Implemented hands-on projects that improved student proficiency in GUI development, resulting in 80% of students completing practical assignments on time.

PROFESSIONAL SERVICES

Conference Chair/Committee Member

- Served as the **Co-Chair** of the Special Session on “Graph Machine Learning for Complex Systems and Applications” at the International Conference on Machine Learning and Applications (ICMLA 2026).
- Served as the **Co-Chair** of the Special Session on “Advances in Multimodal AI: Method and Application” at the IEEE International Conference on Systems, Man, and Cybernetics (IEEE SMC 2026).
- Served as the **Co-Chair** of the Special Session on “Multi-modal Machine Learning in Practice” at the International Conference on Machine Learning and Applications (ICMLA 2026).
- Served as a member of the **Scientific Program Committee** for the 12th IEEE Swiss Conference on Data Science (SDS 2025), taking place on June 26-27, 2025, in Zürich, Switzerland.
- Served as a member of the **Technical Program Committee** for the Special Session on Multi-modal Machine Learning (MAPLE) at International Conference on Machine Learning and Applications (ICMLA 2025).

Invited Talks

- Got invited for a seminar talk on **Cybersecurity and Blockchain** for the Department of Computer Science Seminar Series at Missouri State University, to be held in November 2025.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Assistant Professor, Southern Illinois University Carbondale Aug. 2025 - Present

- Digital Forensics with Graduate and Undergraduate Sections (CS 413/513)
- Problem Solving with Computers (CS 201)

Instructor, Florida International University May. 2024 - Dec. 2024

- Network Protocols for Internet of Things (CNT 4165)
 - Study of network protocols specifically tailored for IoT devices and systems.
 - Covered foundational networking concepts before diving into protocols used in IoT environments, such as MQTT, CoAP, and IPv6. Lab-based learning where students configured and tested IoT devices.

Graduate Teaching Assistant, Florida International University Aug. 2020 - Apr. 2024

- Senior Design Projects (EEL 4920)
 - A capstone experience for senior students, challenging them to apply their academic knowledge to real-world projects.
 - Served as a **mentor for over 100 projects**, guiding students through project planning, design, and implementation phases.
- Digital Forensics (EEL 4802)
 - Exploration of techniques and tools used in digital forensics for the investigation of cyber crimes.
 - Emphasized hands-on labs where students worked on forensic analysis of different digital mediums. Included case studies of real cybercrimes to understand better how forensics is applied.

Lecturer, Daffodil International University May 2018 - Jun. 2018

- Artificial Intelligence (CSE 412 & 413)
 - Comprehensive introduction to artificial intelligence concepts and techniques. Topics included machine learning, natural language processing, robotics, and intelligent agents.
 - Lectures combined with interactive lab sessions to give students hands-on experience. Emphasis on practical applications in AI, encouraging students to solve real-world problems using AI methodologies.

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

IFLIP2 Fellow (Innovative Flipped Learning Instructional Project)

Aug. 2025 – Aug. 2028

- Award ID: NSF Award #2439762, IUSE program
- Selected to participate in a three-year, multi-institutional STEM education reform cohort under the NSF-funded project “Developing STEM Education Reform Leaders through a Multidisciplinary and Cross-Institutional Community of Transformation”. Participating in cross-institutional workshops, symposia, and professional development activities with faculty from partner universities and community colleges.

PEER-REVIEW ACTIVITIES

Journals

- IEEE Transactions on Information Forensics and Security (TIFS) (impact factor: 6.3)
- IEEE Transactions on Industrial Informatics (TII) (impact factor: 12.3)
- IEEE Internet of Things Journal (IoT-J) (impact factor: 10.2)
- IEEE Transactions on Big Data (TBD) (impact factor: 7.5)
- IEEE Transactions on Wireless Communications (TWC) (impact factor: 8.9)
- IEEE Transactions on Dependable and Secure Computing (TDSC) (impact factor: 7.3)
- IEEE Transactions on Vehicular Technology (TVT) (impact factor: 6.8)
- ELSEVIER Computers & Security (impact factor: 4.8)

Conferences

- IEEE International Conference on Communication (ICC)
- Blockchain Research & Applications for Innovative Networks and Services (BRAINS)
- IEEE Wireless Communications and Networking Conference (WCNC)
- Applied Cryptography and Network Security (ACNC)
- International Conference on Network and Service Management (CNSM)
- IEEE SmartGridComm
- IEEE International Conference on Metaverse Computing, Networking and Applications (MetaCom)
- IEEE International Conference on Digital Health (ICDH).

PROFESSIONAL CERTIFICATIONS

- Completed and obtained Microsoft: Security, Compliance, and Identity Fundamentals Certification (**SC-900 Credential**).
- Completed and obtained Microsoft: Azure Fundamentals Certification (**AZ-900 Credential**).
- Completed and obtained Microsoft: Azure Artificial Intelligence Fundamentals Certification (**AI-900 Credential**).

LEADERSHIP AND VOLUNTARY ACTIVITIES

Leadership Roles

- Elected **Secretary** of BSO (an official FIU student organization). Aug. 2023 - Jul. 2024
- Elected **Registered Student Organizations** of **FIU IEEE E-board**. Aug. 2022 - Jul. 2023
- Elected **Registered Student Organizations** of BSO. Aug. 2022 - Jul. 2023
- Chief Technical Coordinator of **IEEE KUET Student Branch**. June 2017 - Feb. 2018
- Former trainer of the software/web application development club **BitToByte**. June 2016 - Apr. 2017
- Former trainer at Bangladesh physics olympiad.

Conference Volunteering

- 2023 IEEE/IFIP Network Operations and Management Symposium (NOMS).
- 2017 3rd International Conference on Electrical Information and Communication Technology (EICT).